

Prize Asset

RADHIKA GUPTA, 38

MD & CEO, Edelweiss AMC, **Mumbai**

From being a self-doubting girl in college to one of India's most powerful businesswomen, Radhika Gupta's journey has been an eventful one. Her birth was a difficult moment—born with complications, she was kept in an incubator for several days, where a grave oversight by a duty nurse left her with a broken neck. The daughter of an Indian diplomat, she grew up on four continents. Graduating from the Wharton School, she faced rejections from several top companies before being hired by McKinsey & Co in 2005. In 2009, while the world was still nursing the wounds of the global financial crisis, Gupta decided to return to India as an entrepreneur, giving up a comfortable job in the US. After a nearly five-year stint as co-founder of Forefront Capital Management, an alternative investment firm, she joined Mumbai-based financial services firm Edelweiss, rising to become the CEO of its mutual funds business in 2017. Under her, the firm's assets under management grew from Rs 6,000 crore in 2017 to Rs 77,000 crore in December 2021. She led the